

Desk buddies

Space-saving scribblers, handy adhesives, and innovative organizers make great desk buddies in schools and offices around the world.

The essentials for keeping you ORGANIZED

Lead pencil

Although the **Babylonians and Egyptians** were inscribing stones and tablets thousands of years ago, it was not until the late 18th century that lead pencils first made their mark. The forerunner to the lead pencil that we use today was invented in **France and Austria** during the 1790s. Erasers were added to the end of pencils in the 1850s. Today, more than **14 BILLION** pencils are manufactured annually.

Ballpoint pen

Early ink pens proved problematic because often the ink inside either **dried up or leaked**. In the 1880s, American John J. Loud developed an early version of the ballpoint pen, which was later improved by Hungarian journalist **LÁSZLÓ BÍRÓ** in the 1940s. A tiny, rotating metal ball added to a tube of ink controlled the flow and prevented drying. More than **100 billion** ballpoint pens have been sold since.

➡ Before the rubber eraser was invented, bread was used to remove pencil marks.